

CASE ID: 199712710732

EPISODE NAME: China Imposes Anti-Dumping Duties on Imported Newsprint (South Korea)

1997/12/11 - 2009/06/30

Sender: China (710)

Target: South Korea (732),

Issue: Trade Practices (13)

Final Outcome: Stalemate after Sanctions Imposition (9)

Summary:

On 1998/06/10, China imposed 9-78 percent tariffs on paper products from South Korea, Canada, and the United States.¹ The tariffs were a result of an anti-dumping investigation and served to protect China's domestic newsprint industry.² The tariffs were lifted on 2009/06/30.³

Narrative:

On 1997/12/11, the Chinese Foreign Trade Ministry threatened the imposition of tariffs ranging from 9-78 percent on paper products from the United States, Canada, and South Korea.⁴ These tariffs were declared on the grounds of alleged dumping, accusing the mentioned countries of selling paper and newsprint in China at prices below international rates.⁵ The tariffs took effect on 1998/06/10.⁶ This was the first time that China had imposed anti-dumping measures, making the case a focus of attention in Chinese industrial and legal circles.⁷

The tariffs were originally scheduled to last for five years. On 2003/05/09, Chinese newsprint producers requested that the Chinese Ministry of Commerce review the trade restrictions, and they were extended for an additional five years.⁸

¹ "China Turns the Page on Paper Tariffs." *e-To-China*, July 2nd, 2009.

https://www.e-to-china.com/tariff_changes/Industry_Influence/2009/0702/56370.html.

² Ibid.

³ "China scraps anti-dumping duty on newsprint imports." *Reuters*, June 29th, 2009.

<https://www.reuters.com/article/china-economy-dumping-idUSPEK5517720090630>.

⁴ Lu, Zhang. "Learning to Use WTO Rules for Protection." *China Daily*, July 6th, 2004.

https://www.chinadaily.com.cn/english/doc/2004-07/06/content_345959.htm

⁵ Ibid.

⁶ Ibid.

⁷ "China scraps anti-dumping duty on newsprint imports." *Reuters*, June 29th, 2009.

<https://www.reuters.com/article/china-economy-dumping-idUSPEK5517720090630>.

⁸ Lu, Zhang. "Learning to Use WTO Rules for Protection." *China Daily*, July 6th, 2004.

https://www.chinadaily.com.cn/english/doc/2004-07/06/content_345959.htm.

The tariffs were lifted on 2009/06/30.⁹ The Chinese newsprint industry had reportedly progressed to the point that it could compete with foreign companies. Growing demand for paper also impacted the decision.¹⁰

⁹ "China scraps anti-dumping duty on newsprint imports." *Reuters*, June 29th, 2009.
<https://www.reuters.com/article/china-economy-dumping-idUSPEK5517720090630>

¹⁰ "China Turns the Page on Paper Tariffs." *e-To-China*, July 2nd, 2009.
https://www.e-to-china.com/tariff_changes/Industry_Influence/2009/0702/56370.html